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ISTANBUL MAYOR'S SUPPORTERS CLASH WITH TURKISH POLICE

Turkish anti-riot police officers use pepper spray to disperse protesters during a rally in support of arrested mayor Ekrem Imamoglu, in Istanbul on Sunday. Istanbul's newly-deposed mayor was taken to a jail on Sunday afternoon, the main CHP opposition party said, as more than 1,100 people, including journalists, were arrested. **SEE ALSO P10**

Dubai tenants can lower rents with single cheque payment

Payment in multiple cheques may see rental rate increases ranging from 5%-25%

DUBAI
BY MANOJ NAIR
Business Editor

Many tenants seeking lease renewals are being offered a lower rent only if they pay the full amount in a single cheque. If they opt for multiple cheques — whether four or six — they face significantly higher rental rates, with increases ranging from 5 per cent to 25 per cent. For tenants, this presents a difficult choice: pay a lump sum upfront or bear the burden of higher rental costs. Some renters have resorted

While rental price hikes in some affordable areas have slowed, they remain at elevated levels after years of steep increases.

to short-term loans or credit cards to cover these payments, adding to their financial strain. The practice has gained traction since the launch of Dubai's digital Rental Index, which categorises properties based on build and maintenance quality. Newer, higher-rated buildings have seen landlords using this classification to justify higher rents. "Landlords view 2024 lease renewals as a prime opportunity to maximise rental in-

come," said a Dubai-based estate agent. "If a few units in a building rent at a higher rate, other landlords follow suit."

Tenants affected

This strategy is impacting both existing and new tenants. While rental price hikes in some affordable areas have slowed, they remain at elevated levels after years of steep increases. "I'm being asked for Dh95,000 to renew my lease, up from Dh74,000," said a tenant. "I can't pay Dh90,000 upfront just to get a lower rent." Experts note that multiple cheque payments have historically come at a premium, but for many tenants, they remain essential for managing monthly budgets — especially as corporate housing allowances decline. **SEE ALSO P5**

Divorces rising in UAE, with some marriages lasting hours

448 divorces recorded across four emirates last year

ABU DHABI
BY ABDULLA RASHEED
Abu Dhabi Editor

The UAE Ministry of Justice has revealed a concerning rise in the number of divorces in the UAE, with some marriages having lasted for only a few hours.

According to the ministry, one of the divorces was recorded just 24 hours after the wedding.

The ministry, which recorded a total of 448 divorces across four emirates — 217 in Sharjah, 139 in Ajman, 70 in Fujairah and 22 in Umm Al Quwain — in 2024, said some dissolutions occurred for seemingly irrational or trivial reasons. Several marriages ended within a week, including one divorce just five days after the wedding,

GREY DIVORCE

Grey divorce, referring to divorce among couples aged 50 and older, is on the rise globally. According to a legal expert, couples in this demographic often reassess personal goals and prioritise happiness, independence and self-fulfillment over traditional notions of staying together "forever".

two cases after seven days, and numerous others within a month. At the other end of the spectrum, the data also highlighted some long-term marriages ending in divorce.

They included cases occurring after 47, 46, and 45 years of marriage, along with many other cases where couples had been married for more than 30 years before deciding to part ways. **SEE ALSO P2**

WORLD

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HEALTH

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Half of Hamas cabinet killed in Israeli strikes

LATEST CASUALTY WAS BEING TREATED IN A HOSPITAL WHEN HE WAS HIT

GAZA

Israel killed two members of Hamas's de facto cabinet during a renewed Gaza offensive aimed at eliminating the Iran-backed militant group's role as a military and governing force. That brought to 11 the death toll within the 20-person forum.

After Salah Al Badawil was hit in the southern Gaza Strip by air strikes on Sunday, another Israeli air strike killed a member of Hamas's political bureau as he underwent treatment in hospital, a source in the Islamist movement said, after Israel confirmed it targeted "a key terrorist".

"The Israeli army assassinated Hamas political bureau member Ismail Barhoum," the Hamas source said, requesting anonymity to speak more freely.

Nasser hospital bombed

"Warplanes bombed the operating room at Nasser Hospital in Khan Younis, where Barhoum was receiving treatment after sustaining critical injuries in an air strike targeting his home in Khan Younis at dawn last Tuesday."

AFP photos showed the building of about four-storeys largely undamaged except for fire blazing in one section off a stairwell.

Barhoum is the fourth member of Hamas's political bureau killed since last Tuesday when

730

Palestinians killed since March 18; 57 in the past 24 hours

Israel resumed air strikes in the territory after an impasse over continuing a ceasefire.

Israel's military confirmed the hospital strike which it said was conducted with "precise munitions" following extensive intelligence-gathering.

It said in a statement that the target was a key member of "the Hamas terrorist organisation who was operating inside the Nasser Hospital compound," the military said.

The Ministry of Health in Hamas-run Gaza said Israeli forces "have just targeted the surgery building inside the Nasser Medical Complex, which houses many patients and wounded individuals, and a large fire has erupted at the site."

Gaza's civil defence rescue agency said the hospital's emergency department had been targeted. The health ministry in Hamas-run Gaza said yesterday that 730 people had been killed since Israel resumed bombardments on the Palestinian territory on March 18, including 57 in the past 24 hours. — Agencies **SEE ALSO P10**



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